

The Pre-AI Digital Divide and Firm Productivity across Asia’s Institutional Regimes: Firm-Level Evidence from 50 Economies

Đỗ Thùy Hương^{1 2}
Phan Anh Tú²

¹ Vinh Long University of Technology Education (VLUTE), Vinh Long, Viet Nam ² School of Economics, Can Tho University (CTU), Can Tho, Viet Nam

Corresponding author: Đỗ Thùy Hương — huongdt@vlute.edu.vn — ORCID 0000-0002-7711-2487 **Co-author:** Phan Anh Tú — patu@ctu.edu.vn — ORCID 0000-0003-0667-3137

Target: *Journal of Economics and Development* — Special Issue “Sustainable Growth and Welfare in the Age of Artificial Intelligence” (Emerald; Scopus/ESCI/DOAJ/ABDC; diamond open access, no APC; submission window 1 June – 31 October 2026).

Acknowledgements: This study draws on the corresponding author’s doctoral dissertation programme at Can Tho University. World Bank Enterprise Survey micro-data are used under the programme’s research licence.

Funding: No external funding. **Conflicts of interest:** none declared. **Data and code availability:** WBES micro-data are available from the World Bank Enterprise Surveys portal upon registration; the full replication scripts (digital-divide estimation, robustness battery, and the GNI income-axis merge) accompany the submission under `jed_ai_digital/replication/`.

AI-use disclosure: Generative-AI tools were used to assist with drafting, code refactoring, and language editing. All research design, variable construction, model specification, estimation, interpretation, and final scientific decisions are the authors’; the authors take full responsibility for the content. All reported quantitative results are reproducible from the accompanying scripts.